

1876-77

JUNE 1876

Presidential nominations are Rutherford Hayes, Republican, and Samuel Tilden, Democrat.



Republican candidates, 1876 election

NOVEMBER 1876

In the presidential election Tilden wins a small majority in the popular vote, but the Republicans challenge the validity of the returns in three Southern states on the grounds of intimidation.

MARCH 1877

A Congressional commission awards the disputed presidential election to Hayes, who is inaugurated later in the month.

APRIL 1877

Hayes begins to fulfil the political bargain that has won him the presidency by awarding the governorship of South Carolina to a "redeemer." Federal support for Reconstruction is now effectively abandoned.